Bow Drill



Category: **Hand Tools - Cutting & Shaping** Type: **Short SOP** Priority: **Medium** 1 labs

Covers these lab items: Bow hand drill

What it is used for

A bow drill rotates a drill bit using a bow and cord to create holes in suitable materials. Secure the workpiece and use controlled motion to prevent slipping.

How to use

1. Inspect the bow, cord, spindle, drill bit, and bearing surfaces for damage.
2. Select a suitable bit and confirm it is securely fitted.
3. Mark the hole location and clamp the workpiece firmly.
4. Position the drill bit at the mark and hold the tool upright.
5. Move the bow steadily back and forth while maintaining controlled pressure.
6. Stop before adjusting the bit or clearing chips from the hole.
7. Remove the drill carefully and clean the tool after use.

⚠ Safety

- Wear eye protection and keep fingers clear of the rotating bit.
- Secure the workpiece rather than holding small pieces in your hand.
- Keep loose clothing and hair away from the moving cord and spindle.
- Do not use a cracked bow, frayed cord, or damaged bit.

Care & storage

- Remove dust and chips, inspect the cord, and store the drill in a dry place.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.